used to installing in, until he felt ready to reveal this work beyond its points of process.

Outside his time spent as a teacher in West Berlin, Tajiri made brief visits back home, as short interruptions in his longer exile. For Tajiri, the Berlin Wall remained a site of prominent contact, where he continued to treat the city and its border area as a forlorn transnational American space. In 1981, for the wall's twentieth anniversary, Tajiri took 360-degree panoramas of twenty-four prominent intersections. On Snelson's advice, he used a Widelux F7 camera and, rather than moving upward through the entire city, found a way to hint at the contours of shape in an image. The newest generation of the Wall, Grenzmauer 75, bears signs of a descent into disrepair, new graffiti, and on its periphery, the continued presence of American sector signs (fig. 3.6). In one photo, the sign is covered in a dried glob of paint. The sign has been absorbed into the blank canvas imagined as the Wall. In another, Tajiri is able to capture the "other" side of the typical American sector sign, still from the west, marking entrance as opposed to exit. Set against a bleak, up-close view of the Wall, plain without graffiti, cropped to avoid its rounded top, a Christmas tree cast aside at its footprint, at its walkway at its base, the sign is the telling detail of the far right-hand side, the far end of the 360-degree image (fig. 3.7). The signs reads, in English, "You Are Entering the American Sector / Carrying Weapons Off Duty Forbidden / Obey Traffic Rules." Tajiri's approach gives a view of the border scene from inside out. This seems to be the first time he has documented the view of the other side of the sign in any of his images, which would have been seen in a previous era upon exiting East Berlin, but then faced the Wall instead. However, he provides no significant views of the American sector beyond this one, or a clear view of the sign. He prefers to stay on the city's margins, perched almost at the point where the sector signs are located, close to the Wall. Of his panoramas, he made prints, on both paper and linen (which he called "Berlinens"), and intended to build a room for viewers to walk into—not a sculpture of the Wall but a monumental form to share his perspective.[46]

